



iPhone manufacture suspended

Foxconn and Wistron both suspended manufacturing Apple devices in India.
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Teardown: Xiaomi Mi Watch

Aping and undercutting
the competition

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Somewhat similar, subtly different

The Xiaomi Mi Watch does bear a certain resemblance to the Apple Watch Series 5, however, there are a few subtle differences which separate the watches from each other. The Mi Watch seems to be more boxy and squarish in comparison to the more rounded corners on the Apple Watch. Additionally, the bezel on the Mi Watch is also a tad wider and hosts two flappy mounts for the detachable band.



Extracting the screen

The screen makes way after applying a fair bit of heat and gentle prying with a thin but sturdy opening tool. However, this process does damage the metal around the screen. The screen is still tethered to the body of the Mi Watch by a flex cable which can be taken off by loosening a bracket and unplugging the display. Off comes the 1.76-inch Super AMOLED display boasting a 368x448 resolution as well as a tiny, circular cutout for the light sensor. On the back of the screen, there's a Cypress multi-touch capacitive touchscreen controller.



Smaller LRA

The midframe of the Mi Watch houses the speaker in a red rubber protective cover, the buttons for the crown of the watch, the home button and finally, the LRA (linear resonant actuator). This is responsible for the vibrations on the watch, however, in comparison to the Apple Watch's Taptic Engine LRA, the one on the Mi Watch is noticeably smaller in size. Turning the digital crown on the Watch provides haptic feedback, but the intensity may not be as much as its Apple counterpart. Still, Apple trades a lot of battery life for the larger LRA.